

Collections Refunds and Settlement Procedure

Document SOP-16 | Version 1.0 | Approved | Effective 2026-09-01

Owner: Operations Manager. Approval authority: Managing Director. Scope: Finance Associate. Review due: 2027-09-01. Valid until: No scheduled expiry.

Purpose and application

Maintain separation of duties and complete reconciliation for collections, refunds and merchant settlements.

Role mandate: Reconcile collections and prepare evidence-backed settlements and refunds. Reports to: Operations Manager. Department: Finance. Delegated authority is limited to the steps below; independent financial or policy approval remains with the named approver.

4.1 Reconcile collections

REQ-SOP-16-01 | Mandatory

The Finance Associate must reconcile collection records against shipment events and received funds each working day. Unexplained differences must remain in a tracked exception queue.

Evidence: Daily reconciliation and exception register.

4.2 Validate refund approval

REQ-SOP-16-02 | Mandatory

The Finance Associate must verify return eligibility evidence and independent Operations Manager payment approval before processing any refund. The preparer must not approve the same payment.

Evidence: Refund evidence, independent approval and preparer identity.

4.3 Prevent duplicate payments

REQ-SOP-16-03 | Mandatory

The Finance Associate must check shipment, return and payment identifiers before releasing funds. A possible duplicate must be held until resolved by the Operations Manager.

Evidence: Duplicate check and hold decision.

4.4 Verify bank changes

REQ-SOP-16-04 | Mandatory

The Finance Associate must verify settlement-detail changes through a previously registered merchant contact and obtain Operations Manager approval. Contact details in the change request must not serve as the verification channel.

Evidence: Independent verification and approved change history.

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4.5 Prepare settlements

REQ-SOP-16-05 | Mandatory

The Finance Associate must reconcile fees, collections and approved adjustments before preparing a merchant settlement statement. Each adjustment requires a source record.

Evidence: Settlement statement and adjustment evidence.

4.6 Release settlement

REQ-SOP-16-06 | Mandatory

The Finance Associate must obtain independent Operations Manager approval before settlement release and must record the payment reference and release date.

Evidence: Approved settlement and payment reference.

4.7 Restrict financial exports

REQ-SOP-16-07 | Mandatory

The Finance Associate must store working financial exports in approved restricted storage and apply POL-06 to any customer-data copies. A working export must not replace the controlled transaction record.

Evidence: Restricted export record and deletion evidence where applicable.

4.8 Review reconciliation patterns

REQ-SOP-16-08 | Recommended

The Finance Associate may propose a control improvement after analyzing recurring reconciliation exceptions using aggregated data.

Evidence: Optional control improvement proposal.

Training and control

Employees learn the applicable clauses during Week 1 and complete a source-based knowledge check. Task performers demonstrate the relevant procedure before independent work. Mandatory knowledge checks require at least 80 percent; all safety and privacy critical steps must pass. The assessor records requirement IDs, evidence and the source version. An earlier operational deadline still applies. Questions and exceptions follow POL-01; related controls include POL-01, POL-03, POL-05, POL-06 and POL-09.